AURMAK Brand Identity Guidelines v1.0

Document Overview

This comprehensive brand identity guideline document defines the visual language, design principles, and implementation standards for AURMAK, a hybrid venture studio operating at the intersection of technology and strategic capital deployment.

---

1. Brand Overview

Brand Positioning

AURMAK is a **hybrid venture studio** that combines strategic capital deployment with hands-on venture building. We operate at the intersection of:

- **Strategic Investment**: Capital allocation driven by deep technical and market analysis
- **Venture Building**: Hands-on creation and scaling of technology-driven businesses
- **Operational Excellence**: Engineering-first approach to business creation

Brand Attributes

- **Authoritative**: Enterprise-grade credibility and institutional trust
- **Technical**: Engineering-first, data-driven decision making
- **Precision-focused**: Obsessive attention to detail and systematic execution
- **Future-oriented**: Building infrastructure for tomorrow's economy
- **Understated**: Confident without being ostentatious

Design Philosophy

The AURMAK visual identity is inspired by **Palantir's design language** — a corporate, minimalist, high-tech aesthetic that prioritises:

- Clean, grid-based layouts with abundant whitespace
- Sharp, precise visual hierarchy
- Enterprise-grade professionalism (not playful or startup-like)
- Technical diagrams and data visualisation
- Sophisticated colour restraint
- Institutional credibility

---

2. Logo Guidelines

Logo Construction

The AURMAK wordmark is the primary brand identifier. It features:

- Custom letterforms with technical precision
- Consistent spacing and optical balance
- Available in full-colour, monochrome, and reverse variants

Primary Logo Variants

1. **Full Colour Logo**: Navy (#1B2A6B) wordmark with Cyan (#2CB5E3) accent
2. **Monochrome Dark**: All-Navy (#1B2A6B) for light backgrounds

3. **Monochrome Light**: White/reversed for dark backgrounds
4. **Single Colour Cyan**: Cyan (#2CB5E3) for special applications

Clear Space Requirements

- Minimum clear space: **X-height of the letter 'A'** on all sides
- Never place other design elements or text within this protected zone
- Ensures visual breathing room and brand recognition

Minimum Size Standards

- **Digital/Screen**: Minimum 120px width
- **Print**: Minimum 25mm width
- Never scale below these dimensions to maintain legibility

Logo Do's

✓ Use approved logo files only
✓ Maintain minimum clear space on all sides
✓ Use on backgrounds with sufficient contrast
✓ Scale proportionally (lock aspect ratio)
✓ Use monochrome version when colour is limited

Logo Don'ts

✕ Do not rotate, skew, or distort the logo
✕ Do not apply gradients, shadows, or effects
✕ Do not change the logo colours
✕ Do not place on busy or low-contrast backgrounds
✕ Do not recreate or retype the logo
✕ Do not scale below minimum size requirements

---

3. Colour System

Primary Palette

Deep Navy Blue

- **Hex**: `#1B2A6B`
- **RGB**: 27, 42, 107
- **CMYK**: 75, 61, 0, 58
- **Pantone**: 2765 C (closest match)
- **Usage**: Primary text, headings, authoritative UI elements, dark backgrounds
- **Accessibility**: WCAG AA compliant on white backgrounds

Bright Cyan

- **Hex**: `#2CB5E3`
- **RGB**: 44, 181, 227
- **CMYK**: 81, 20, 0, 11
- **Pantone**: 306 C (closest match)
- **Usage**: Accent colour, interactive elements, call-to-action buttons, data visualisation highlights
- **Accessibility**: Use with caution on white; ensure 4.5:1 contrast for text

Secondary Palette

Charcoal Grey

- **Hex**: `#4A5568`
- **RGB**: 74, 85, 104
- **Usage**: Body text, secondary information, subdued UI elements

Light Grey (Background)

- **Hex**: `#F4F6F8`
- **RGB**: 244, 246, 248
- **Usage**: Page backgrounds, card backgrounds, subtle separators

Border Grey

- **Hex**: `#E5E7EB`
- **RGB**: 229, 231, 235
- **Usage**: Borders, dividers, subtle visual separators

Pure White

- **Hex**: `#FFFFFF`
- **RGB**: 255, 255, 255
- **Usage**: Primary backgrounds, card surfaces, text on dark backgrounds

Pure Black

- **Hex**: `#000000`
- **RGB**: 0, 0, 0
- **Usage**: Maximum contrast situations (use sparingly)

Colour Usage Principles

- **Hierarchy**: Navy for primary, Cyan for accent/interaction
- **Contrast**: Always maintain WCAG AA (4.5:1) minimum for text
- **Restraint**: Use colour purposefully, not decoratively
- **Consistency**: Apply colours systematically across all touchpoints

Accessibility Standards

- **Text on White**: Navy (#1B2A6B) passes WCAG AAA
- **Interactive Elements**: Cyan (#2CB5E3) minimum 3:1 for large text
- **Focus States**: Ensure visible focus indicators for keyboard navigation
- **Print**: Test all colour combinations for colour-blind accessibility

---

4. Typography System

Primary Typeface: Inter

Inter is a highly legible sans-serif typeface designed for user interfaces and digital screens. It features:

- Excellent readability at small sizes
- Neutral, professional character
- Open-source and widely available
- Extensive weight range (100-900)

Font Weights & Usage

Inter Black (900)

- **Usage**: Large display headings, hero text
- **Size Range**: 48px - 72px+
- **Line Height**: 1.1
- **Letter Spacing**: -0.02em (tight tracking for large sizes)

Inter Bold (700)

- **Usage**: Section headings (H2, H3), emphasis text
- **Size Range**: 24px - 36px
- **Line Height**: 1.3
- **Letter Spacing**: -0.01em

Inter Semi-Bold (600)

- **Usage**: Subheadings (H4), UI labels, navigation
- **Size Range**: 16px - 20px
- **Line Height**: 1.4
- **Letter Spacing**: 0

Inter Medium (500)

- **Usage**: Body emphasis, button text, list items
- **Size Range**: 14px - 18px
- **Line Height**: 1.5
- **Letter Spacing**: 0

Inter Regular (400)

- **Usage**: Body copy, paragraph text, descriptions
- **Size Range**: 14px - 18px
- **Line Height**: 1.6
- **Letter Spacing**: 0

Typography Hierarchy

```
H1 (Page Title)
- Font: Inter Black (900)
- Size: 48px
- Colour: #1B2A6B
- Line Height: 1.1
- Use Case: Primary page headings

H2 (Section Heading)
- Font: Inter Bold (700)
- Size: 28px – 32px
- Colour: #1B2A6B
- Line Height: 1.3
- Use Case: Major section divisions

H3 (Subsection Heading)
- Font: Inter Bold (700)
- Size: 20px – 24px
- Colour: #1B2A6B
- Line Height: 1.4
- Use Case: Content subsections
```

```
H4 (Component Heading)
- Font: Inter Semi-Bold (600)
- Size: 16px - 18px
- Colour: #1B2A6B
- Line Height: 1.4
- Use Case: Card titles, component labels

Body Text
- Font: Inter Regular (400)
- Size: 16px
- Colour: #4A5568
- Line Height: 1.6
- Use Case: Paragraphs, descriptions

Small Text / Captions
- Font: Inter Regular (400)
- Size: 12px - 14px
- Colour: #4A5568
- Line Height: 1.5
- Use Case: Metadata, captions, footnotes
```

Typography Principles

- **Hierarchy**: Use size, weight, and colour to establish clear information hierarchy
- **Readability**: Maintain generous line height (1.5-1.6) for body text
- **Consistency**: Limit to 3-4 type sizes per layout
- **Alignment**: Left-align text for maximum readability; center only for display purposes

---

5. Visual Direction

Photography Style

Corporate Environment Photography

- **Subject Matter**: Professional office environments, modern workspace interiors, technology infrastructure
- **Tone**: Clean, professional, aspirational but authentic
- **Lighting**: Natural light, bright and airy, minimal shadows
- **Composition**: Wide angles, architectural precision, geometric clarity
- **Colour Grading**: Cool tones, slightly desaturated, professional colour balance
- **People**: Candid shots (not posed), diverse professionals in modern work environments

Image Characteristics

- **High-quality**: Professional photography only, minimum 1920px width
- **Authentic**: Real office environments, not overly staged stock imagery
- **Geometric**: Clean lines, architectural elements, spatial balance
- **Technology-focused**: Screens, devices, data visualisation when appropriate
- **Minimal clutter**: Clean, organised spaces that reflect operational excellence

Mood Board Keywords

- "Modern office architecture natural light"
- "Professional workspace minimalist"

- "Tech company headquarters interior"
- "Contemporary business environment"
- "Data centre technology infrastructure"
- "Enterprise software development team"

Graphic Elements

Grid Systems

- **8-point grid**: All spacing and sizing based on multiples of 8px
- **Column grids**: 12-column layout for responsive design
- **Gutters**: Minimum 24px between content blocks

Iconography

- **Style**: Line icons, minimal, geometric
- **Weight**: 2px stroke weight for consistency
- **Library**: Lucide React or custom technical icons
- **Colour**: Navy (#1B2A6B) or Cyan (#2CB5E3) only

Data Visualisation

- **Charts**: Clean, minimal styling with clear labels
- **Colours**: Use primary palette (Navy + Cyan) with grey accents
- **Library**: Recharts for React applications
- **Accessibility**: Always include text alternatives and legends

---

6. UI Components & Design System

Component Library: Ant Design 6.3.0

AURMAK uses **Ant Design (AntD) 6.3.0** as the primary enterprise UI library, customised with brand tokens.

Theme Configuration

```
import { ConfigProvider } from 'antd';

<ConfigProvider
  theme={{
    token: {
      colorPrimary: '#2CB5E3',      // Bright Cyan
      colorInfo: '#2CB5E3',          // Info states
      colorTextBase: '#1B2A6B',      // Primary text colour
      fontFamily: 'Inter, sans-serif'
    },
    components: {
      Button: {
        colorPrimary: '#2CB5E3',
        colorPrimaryHover: '#1B9BC4'
      }
    }
  }}
>
```

```
  {/* Your app components */}
</ConfigProvider>
```

Spacing System (8pt Grid)

```
4pt  = 1 (Tailwind: space-1)
8pt  = 2 (Tailwind: space-2)
16pt = 4 (Tailwind: space-4)
24pt = 6 (Tailwind: space-6)
32pt = 8 (Tailwind: space-8)
48pt = 12 (Tailwind: space-12)
64pt = 16 (Tailwind: space-16)
```

Corner Radius Standards

- **Default Components**: 8px (AntD 6.3 default) — buttons, inputs, cards
- **Full Rounded**: 9999px — badges, pills, status indicators
- **Sharp (Special Cases)**: 2px — technical diagrams, data tables

Button Variants

Primary Button

```
<Button type="primary">Primary Action</Button>
```

- Background: #2CB5E3 (Bright Cyan)
- Text: White
- Hover: #1B9BC4 (Darker Cyan)
- Use: Primary calls-to-action

Default/Secondary Button

```
<Button>Secondary Action</Button>
```

- Background: White
- Border: Grey
- Text: #1B2A6B (Navy)
- Use: Secondary actions, cancel

Ghost/Text Button

```
<Button type="text">Tertiary Action</Button>
```

- Background: Transparent
- Text: #1B2A6B (Navy)
- Use: Tertiary actions, inline links

Link Button

```
<Button type="link">Link Action</Button>
```

- No background
- Text: #2CB5E3 (Cyan)
- Underline on hover
- Use: Navigation, inline actions

Form Inputs

Text Input

```
<Input placeholder="Enter text..." />
```

- Border: 1px solid #E5E7EB
- Focus: 2px solid #2CB5E3
- Padding: 8px 12px
- Font: Inter Regular 16px

Select Dropdown

```
<Select placeholder="Select option" />
```

- Same styling as Input
- Dropdown: white background, subtle shadow

Cards

```
<Card title="Card Title">
  Content here
</Card>
```

- Background: White
- Border: 1px solid #E5E7EB
- Border Radius: 8px
- Padding: 24px
- Shadow: Subtle (0 1px 3px rgba(0,0,0,0.1))

Tags & Status Indicators

```
<Tag color="cyan">Active</Tag>
<Tag color="processing">In Progress</Tag>
```

- Use for status labels, categories
- Colours: cyan (primary), processing (blue), success (green)

Accessibility Requirements

- **Keyboard Navigation**: All interactive elements must be keyboard accessible
- **Focus States**: Visible focus indicators (2px solid #2CB5E3)
- **Contrast**: Minimum 4.5:1 for text, 3:1 for interactive components
- **ARIA Labels**: Proper labelling for screen readers
- **Alt Text**: All images must have descriptive alt text

---

7. Tone of Voice

Brand Voice Attributes

Professional

- Use industry-standard terminology
- Avoid jargon unless speaking to technical audiences
- Maintain grammatical precision
- Use British English spelling (colour, organisation, capitalise)

Confident

- Make definitive statements backed by data
- Avoid hedging language ("perhaps", "maybe", "we think")
- Use active voice over passive
- Example: "We build ventures" not "Ventures are built by us"

Precise

- Use specific data points and metrics
- Avoid vague qualifiers ("very", "quite", "really")
- Choose exact words over approximations
- Example: "£2.4M deployed" not "approximately £2M+"

Technical

- Comfortable with technical language when appropriate
- Explain complex concepts with clarity
- Use data and evidence to support claims
- Balance technical depth with accessibility

Authoritative (Not Arrogant)

- Demonstrate expertise through insight, not boasting
- Focus on outcomes and results
- Give credit where due
- Avoid superlatives unless substantiated

Writing Guidelines

Headlines & Titles

- Short, punchy, declarative
- Use sentence case (not title case)
- No full stops at the end
- Example: "Building ventures that scale infrastructure"

Body Copy

- Keep sentences under 25 words
- One idea per paragraph
- Use lists and bullet points for clarity
- Front-load important information

Calls-to-Action

- Use action verbs
- Be specific about what happens next
- Examples:

    - ✓ "Schedule a consultation"
    - ✕ "Learn more"

Technical Content

- Define acronyms on first use
- Use code blocks for technical examples
- Include context for technical readers and non-technical stakeholders
- Link to additional resources for deeper dives

British English Standards

Spelling

- colour (not color)
- organisation (not organization)
- capitalise (not capitalize)
- analysed (not analyzed)
- programme (not program, except for computer programs)
- centre (not center)

Punctuation

- Use single quotation marks for quotes
- Place punctuation outside quotes (unless part of the quoted material)
- Use Oxford comma for clarity in lists
- Use en-dash (–) for ranges, em-dash (—) for breaks

Date Format

- DD Month YYYY (21 February 2026)
- Avoid MM/DD/YYYY format

Numbers

- Spell out numbers one to nine
- Use numerals for 10 and above
- Use commas for thousands (1,000 not 1000)
- Use "per cent" not "%" in body copy (% acceptable in tables/charts)

Content Examples

✓ Good Example

"AURMAK deployed £2.4M across three ventures in Q4 2025, focusing on infrastructure software and enterprise tooling. Each venture underwent rigorous technical due diligence and market validation before capital allocation."

✕ Poor Example

"AURMAK has deployed approximately $2M+ across some really cool ventures recently. We're super excited about the infrastructure space and think it's going to be huge!"

---

8. Layout & Grid Principles

Page Structure

Maximum Content Width

- **Desktop**: 1280px maximum width
- **Centered**: Content centered with equal margins
- **Padding**: Minimum 32px horizontal padding on container

Responsive Breakpoints

```
Mobile:  320px – 767px
Tablet:  768px – 1023px
Desktop: 1024px – 1279px
Wide:    1280px+
```

Vertical Rhythm

- **Section Spacing**: 64px - 96px between major sections
- **Content Spacing**: 24px - 32px between content blocks
- **Element Spacing**: 16px between related elements
- **Line Spacing**: 8px between list items

Whitespace Principles

- **Generous**: Use whitespace liberally to create breathing room
- **Purposeful**: Whitespace creates visual hierarchy and grouping
- **Consistent**: Maintain consistent spacing patterns throughout
- **Asymmetric**: Don't be afraid of unequal margins for visual interest

Grid Layout

12-Column Grid

- **Columns**: 12 equal-width columns
- **Gutter**: 24px between columns
- **Margin**: 32px minimum on sides

Common Layouts

- **Full Width**: 12 columns (hero sections, images)
- **2 Column**: 6/6 split (equal content blocks)
- **Sidebar**: 8/4 or 9/3 split (main content + sidebar)
- **3 Column**: 4/4/4 split (features, team, services)
- **4 Column**: 3/3/3/3 split (stats, benefits, icons)

---

9. Technical Implementation

Technology Stack

Frontend Framework

- **React 18.3.1**: Primary UI framework
- **TypeScript**: Type-safe development
- **Vite**: Build tool and dev server

Styling

- **Tailwind CSS 4.x**: Utility-first CSS framework
- **Ant Design 6.3.0**: Enterprise component library
- **Custom CSS**: Defined in `/src/styles/theme.css`

Icon Library

- **Lucide React**: Primary icon library
- **@ant-design/icons**: AntD-specific icons

File Structure

```
/src
  /app
    /components
      - CoverPage.tsx
      - BrandOverview.tsx
      - LogoUsage.tsx
      - ColorSystem.tsx
      - Typography.tsx
      - VisualDirection.tsx
      - UIComponents.tsx
      - ToneOfVoice.tsx
    - App.tsx
  /styles
    - theme.css
    - fonts.css
  /imports
    - (logo images and assets)
```

Font Loading

```
/* /src/styles/fonts.css */
@import url('https://fonts.googleapis.com/css2?
family=Inter:wght@100;200;300;400;500;600;700;800;900&display=swap');
```

Image Assets

Raster Images (PNG, JPG)

```
// Use local relative asset paths
import logoImage from '../assets/logo-primary.png';
```

SVG Vectors

```
// Use relative file paths
import iconPaths from '../imports/svg-[hash]';
```

Stock Photography

- **Source**: Unsplash API for high-quality professional imagery
- **Keywords**: "modern office architecture", "professional workspace", "tech infrastructure"
- **License**: Unsplash free license (commercial use permitted)

Responsive Design Approach

Mobile-First

- Design for mobile (320px) first
- Progressive enhancement for larger screens
- Touch-friendly targets (minimum 44px)

Breakpoint Strategy

```
/* Tailwind breakpoints */
sm:  640px  @media (min-width: 640px)
md:  768px  @media (min-width: 768px)
lg:  1024px @media (min-width: 1024px)
xl:  1280px @media (min-width: 1280px)
2xl: 1536px @media (min-width: 1536px)
```

---

10. Print Specifications

Document Formats

Digital/Screen

- **Format**: PDF (for distribution)
- **Resolution**: 72 DPI
- **Colour Space**: RGB
- **Fonts**: Embedded

Print

- **Format**: PDF/X-1a or PDF/X-4
- **Resolution**: 300 DPI minimum
- **Colour Space**: CMYK
- **Bleed**: 3mm on all sides
- **Safe Area**: 5mm margin from trim

Business Card Specifications

- **Size**: 85mm × 55mm (standard UK)
- **Finish**: Matt or soft-touch laminate
- **Stock**: 400gsm premium card
- **Colours**: CMYK with spot Pantone option

Letterhead Specifications

- **Size**: A4 (210mm × 297mm)
- **Logo Placement**: Top left, 20mm from top and left edge
- **Footer**: Address and contact details, 15mm from bottom

---

11. Digital Applications

Website Requirements

Performance

- **Load Time**: Under 3 seconds on 3G
- **Core Web Vitals**: Pass all Google CWV metrics

- **Accessibility**: WCAG 2.1 AA compliance minimum

SEO Considerations

- Semantic HTML structure
- Proper heading hierarchy (H1 → H6)
- Alt text for all images
- Meta descriptions and Open Graph tags

Email Templates

Layout

- **Maximum Width**: 600px
- **Font Fallbacks**: Inter, Arial, Helvetica, sans-serif
- **Inline CSS**: All styles inline for email client compatibility
- **Dark Mode**: Provide dark mode optimised styles

Signature Block

```
[Name]
[Title]
AURMAK

[Email] | [Phone]
[Website URL]
```

Social Media

Profile Images

- **LinkedIn**: 400px × 400px (square logo mark)
- **Twitter**: 400px × 400px (square logo mark)
- **Banner Images**: 1584px × 396px (full-colour wordmark on navy or white)

Post Graphics

- **Dimensions**: 1200px × 628px (standard social share)
- **Logo Placement**: Bottom left or top left
- **Colour**: Navy background with white text, or white background with navy text

---

12. Quality Assurance Checklist

Before Publishing Any Brand Material

Visual Compliance

- [ ] Logo used from approved asset library (not recreated)
- [ ] Minimum clear space maintained around logo
- [ ] Logo not scaled below minimum size
- [ ] Colours match exact hex values (#1B2A6B, #2CB5E3)
- [ ] Typography uses Inter font family only
- [ ] Spacing follows 8pt grid system

Content Compliance

- [ ] Tone of voice matches brand guidelines (professional, confident, precise)
- [ ] British English spelling and grammar used throughout
- [ ] No superlatives unless backed by data
- [ ] Technical terms defined on first use
- [ ] Active voice used predominantly

Technical Compliance

- [ ] Accessibility: WCAG AA minimum contrast ratios met
- [ ] Accessibility: Alt text provided for all images
- [ ] Accessibility: Keyboard navigation functional
- [ ] Responsive: Layout tested on mobile, tablet, desktop
- [ ] Performance: Page load under 3 seconds

Legal & Governance

- [ ] All photography properly licensed
- [ ] Copyright notices included where required
- [ ] Third-party trademarks used correctly
- [ ] Privacy policy and legal disclaimers included where applicable

---

13. Version History & Governance

Document Version

- **Version**: 1.0
- **Date**: February 2026
- **Status**: Active

Change Management

- **Owner**: AURMAK Brand & Design Team
- **Review Cycle**: Quarterly
- **Approval Required**: Head of Design + Chief Marketing Officer

Requesting Changes

1. Submit proposal via internal design system repository
2. Include rationale and use case examples
3. Await review by Brand & Design team
4. If approved, updated guidelines published with version increment

Getting Help

- **Design System Questions**: design-system@aurmak.com
- **Asset Requests**: brand-assets@aurmak.com
- **Implementation Support**: engineering@aurmak.com

Appendix A: Quick Reference

Colour Palette Quick Reference

```
Primary Navy:    #1B2A6B
Primary Cyan:    #2CB5E3
Body Text Grey:  #4A5568
Background Grey: #F4F6F8
Border Grey:     #E5E7EB
White:           #FFFFFF
Black:           #000000
```

Typography Quick Reference

```
H1: Inter Black 48px, Navy
H2: Inter Bold 28px, Navy
H3: Inter Bold 20px, Navy
H4: Inter Semi-Bold 16px, Navy
Body: Inter Regular 16px, Grey (#4A5568)
Small: Inter Regular 12px, Grey
```

Spacing Quick Reference

```
4pt, 8pt, 16pt, 24pt, 32pt, 48pt, 64pt
(Multiples of 4 or 8 only)
```

Appendix B: Asset Download Links

Logo Files

- Full-colour logo (PNG, SVG)
- Monochrome dark (PNG, SVG)
- Monochrome light/reverse (PNG, SVG)
- Single-colour cyan (PNG, SVG)

Template Files

- Business card template (AI, PDF)
- Letterhead template (AI, PDF)
- PowerPoint presentation template (PPTX)
- Email signature template (HTML)

Design System Files

- Ant Design theme configuration (JSON)
- Tailwind configuration (JS)

End of Brand Guidelines Document

For questions or clarification, contact: brand@aurmak.com